Finding Catra

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Mature

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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catradora, POV First Person, Adora's POV, Best Friend Squad (She-Ra), Visions, Adora (She-Ra) Needs a Hug, Angella's Memorial (She-Ra), Memories, Finding Halfmoon Series, Finding Halfmoon Extra Chapter

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Part 5 of Finding Halfmoon Series - Prequel Stories and Extra Content Chapters

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Finding Catra

by Midnight_Owl2

Summary

Adora awakes to find that Catra and Melog are missing. She assumes that they have gone for a late night adventure so decides to go about her day as normal. However, as the day goes on Adora starts to worry that she hasn't heard anything from Catra. This is very unusual. It's only when Melog comes to find her that she realises that something is very, very wrong.

Notes

This fic is an extra chapter to my original fic: Finding Halfmoon. To understand this fic, I highly advise reading Finding Halfmoon first.

Finding Halfmoon Readers - This chapter occurs at the same time as Chapter 8 (Halfmoon). This extra chapter explores what is happening in Brightmoon after Catra and Melog went for a midnight walk. It also explores a new side of Adora, in which she openly speaks about her worries. Hope you enjoy. 😊

See the end of the work for more notes

The bed feels cold. Sleep is restless.

I reach over in search of Catra. She won't mind if I steal her body heat. My arm feels around her side of our bed blindly but I can't seem to feel anything or anyone.

That's not right!

Trying not to startle myself to much, I slowly awake, rubbing the sleep from my eyes. It's still dark out but it looks like the sun will begin to rise soon. I love watching the sun rise but it's not the same without Catra here to watch it with me. Besides, she doesn't know the true reason I love watching the sun rise with her by my side. When the sun hits just at the right point, its illuminating glow shines brightly on her beautiful features, which is all of her but the sun really makes her stripes stand out.

The more I look around our room the more concerned I become when I realise Catra is nowhere to be seen. The only thing that settles me is noticing that Melog is also not at the foot of our bed. They're most likely with Catra. They know I hate it when she ventures off alone in the night and they made a promise to me to go with her should she find herself going on a little midnight adventure.

Once my eyes fully adjust to the darkness of our room, I notice a hand written note on my bedside desk. I imagine it's written by Catra as I instantly recognise her handwriting…

***

Couldn't sleep.

Gone for a walk.

Will be back soon.

Promise.

Love you xxx

***

Next to the notes text is Catra's signature mark: the silly drawing that she used to leave me on notes when we were back in the Horde, the same one she drew when she hide that note at the Princess Prom a few years ago.

Holding the note tight in my hand, a small smile creeps across my face. I look over to our more up-to date drawing that we have of ourselves on the wall behind our bed. Catra felt an immense amount of guilt after I first saw our original drawing back in the Fright Zone scratched up. I knew that leaving the Horde hurt her but I never knew to what extent. If anyone should feel guilty it was me, and I'm still incredibly sorry for all the pain and hurt I put her through simply by leaving. We spoke about it a lot, worked out some stuff and eventually decided to create a new one here in Brightmoon. It's not perfect but it's us.

I try my best to fall back asleep after reassuring myself that Catra is with Melog and they will look out for each other. However, sleep doesn't come so I decide that I might as well get ready to start the day and go and watch the sun rise. Getting up this early is only like my old routine back in the Horde. Only this time you're not punished if you sleep in, and there's no battle to be the best out of fear of what someone would do to the person you cared about the most if you didn't meet their expectations.

--

Breakfast was quite this morning, even Wrong Hordak wasn't in the kitchen which was unusual. He's usually one of the first few up so I was surprised to not see him there. I'm not even sure if he sleeps. Maybe he went back to Dryl to see Entrapta for the day. Wherever he is I hope he was having a nice break.

I opted for a few slices of toast and a warm drink whilst I watched the sunrise. Usually I'd watch the sunrise on mine and Catra's balcony or ever the rooftop gardens, but not this morning. This morning I decided to watch the sunrise somewhere else completely.

"Beautiful sunrise isn't it? I know Glimmer was never a morning person but I know she wakes up to watch it rise on certain days, especially days when she's feeling the pressure or royal duties or is really missing you."

As the sun comes into full view I turn to face the person, or rather memorial, I've been talking to. I know some people say that this is simply a place to remember Angella and the sacrifice she made but to me it still feels like she's listening, maybe even watching over us even though she can't be with here with us.

"She really misses you, you know. We all do. I know it's been a few years now since it all happened but it still hurts. That day still appears in my nightmares sometimes. I know you'd be telling me that it gets easier with time and it has, but there are so many things that I wish I could change. I wish I could have done something more so that you could still be here with us."

The sun illuminates Angella's statue perfectly. The flowers surrounding her open and bloom. The fountain trickles slowly around her feet.

Angela was like a mom to me, someone I could look up to and ask for guidance in my time of need. It was difficult to open up to her a first but she showed me kindness and unconditional love. Her comforting touch and endless support made me realise what I had been missing in the Horde and what it was like to have a parental figure in my life who actually loved and supports you… *I wish Catra had got the chance to experience that.*

"Catra's trying really hard to find a way to correct her mistake. She feels horrible for what she did... *for what happened with the portal.* It keeps her up most night. She'd been creating plans and

strategies on what to do and how to make things right again. If we didn't force her to rest she would have entered 'burn-out' by now."

I for one know how that feels and now Catra to know how that feels. I wish I could have seen the signs before it happen. *What is it with those ruins? Why do they worry me?*

Anyway that is now the point Adora. Catra is safe and okay now and that's all that matters.

Taking a quick sip of my drink to clear my thoughts, I take a deep breath and continue to speak...

"Glimmer was the one who talked sense into her. Accepting that you are stuck in a parallel timeline was difficult for her. She went through a lot as she processed her grief. In a strange way it helped her and Catra bond. As much as we'd all love to have you back Angella I think Glimmer has now accepted that the possibility of getting you back is a slim one. Even Entrapta's data states that, *at the moment*, there is only a one percent chance that we'd succeed. As upsetting as that is I know Catra would gladly take that risk… so is it selfish of me to not want her to try?"

I would love nothing more than to have Angella back with us here in Brightmoon. Glimmer would have her mom back, Micah would have his wife back and Catra would more than likely have the opportunity to learn what it's like to have a mother figure in her life. It's not like we haven't tried simulated versions of the plans we set out to get Angella back, we really did try but the end result was just as bad as when the portal initially opened, maybe worse. It hurt us all knowing that the only possible outcome would cause more damage than good, but Catra still wanted to try despite the outcome. It took us a while to get her to see why it was too dangers to even try. I want to live my life with Catra now and forever. I almost lost her once before and I'm not prepared to lose her again. I now see what she meant when she said, *"It doesn't always have to be you"* back when I obtained the failsafe.

“I would love to have you back here with us Angella but I can’t risk losing someone else I love too. If anyone should be stuck in that portal dimension it should be me, but then none of this would have happened. How would have taken the failsafe and would have it worked? Stars knows what would have happened to Catra, the others and Etheria? Your sacrifice gave me the chance to live, the chance to learn and love, the chance to be with my soulmate.”

I try my best to hold back my tears but it becomes a struggle, so I decide to let a few fall. I remember that times when thing were difficult, times when I felt that my efforts were useless. It made it worse because I missed Catra so much and as much as I tried I could never see her as the enemy. The enemy was the Horde, Catra was just a piece in their battle.That was the one thing I was never able to tell anyone as I knew they would never understand.

Angella knew when I needed someone to talk to, even if I didn’t know what to say. She'd sit beside me, hold me close and let me cry against her shoulder as I let my worries pour out to form words. I did the same for Glimmer when Angella was gone. Now we all look after each other. We all laugh, we cry, but at the end of the day we’re there for each other no matter what.

“When you left us you told me to *“take care of each other”*. At the time I though you meant just me and Glimmer, but now I realise you meant so much more. I promise you now Angella that we won’t stop fighting to find a way to get you back but right now the risk is too great. We will find a way I know we will, but now is not the right time. We miss you Angella, we all do. Please… forgive me.”

Recently, I have spoken to Glimmer and Micah about all this and they agree with me that the risk at the moment is too great to even try. They wouldn’t even want to risk it with the possibility of us losing someone else we care about being so high. I know we all want Angella back and Catra wants to make up for what she did but I can’t lose her. *I can't lose her again.* Our lives together have only just begun so don’t we deserve to live it?

A gentle breeze of wind, carrying some of the petals from Angella's flowers fly past my hair. It's enough to make me smile and dry my tears away. It's as if Angella is listening to my every word and telling me not to worry about her and to live my life… *"take care of each other."*

I spend roughly the next half hour with Angella, simply talking about random stuff and allowing my racing thoughts to relax once again. When I get back to my room I notice that Catra still isn't back yet. I wouldn't usually be this worried but she usually sends me a good morning message from her travel tech-pad by now if she went out during the night. Sensing that my nerves won't be settling anytime soon, I decide to go out for a little fly with Swift Wind and to see Madam Razz.

Who knows, maybe Catra will be with her.

--

"Seriously Adora what's bothering you? And don't try saying *nothing* again. Not only are you terrible at lying but in case you have forgotten, I am tuned to your emotions through our sacred bond. If there's something I can do to help just ask."

Swift Wind has become increasingly concerned on our flight to visit Razz. He keeps saying that I'm not my usual self and I keep forgetting that there's no point in hiding anything from him as he can *literally* feel what I feeling emotionally.

"I'm worried about Catra. It's not like her to go off in the middle of night without sending me a message to let me know she's okay when she's been gone this long. She hasn't been sleeping well Swifty and it worries me a little bit."

"Isn't Melog with her?"

"I imagine so. They were gone when I awoke this morning but I can't help but feel that something isn't right. When Catra's gone on an adventure alone before I've been fine with it but there's a feeling of unease in my stomach."

"Maybe you've eaten a bad apple."

"I haven't eaten any apples recently Swift Wind because *you* have been eating them all."

Swift Wind laughs nervously, doing his best to avoid the topic, as he smoothly lands on the ground outside of Razz's hut. I gently stroke his mane as I dismount. As I go to walk away towards the hut door, Swift Wind gently tugs on my jacket lapel and pulls me back towards him. He turns me round and rests his giant head over my shoulder and wraps his wings around me. Without second thought I wrap my arms around his neck and hold him tightly.

"Thanks Swifty."

"Anytime Adora. You know I'm always here for you."

After a moment or two the drape over the hut entrance moves to the side and a familiar face appears…

"Adora dearie. I didn't expect to see you back so soon. You brought Swift Wind too. How nice to see you both."

Razz continues sweeping the entrance of her hut as Swift Wind subtlety leans over and whispers… *"Since when did she finally realise you were Adora. I thought she always got you muddled up with Mara."*

Whilst Razz is still distracted, I whisper back to him… *"About a few months after the Heart of Etheria was deactivated. I think releasing the Magic in some way helped her to recognise timelines a bit better. I don't know it's just a theory Entrapta mentioned."*

Swift Wind has been to see Razz every now and then but this is the first time we've been able to visit her together in a good few months. Everytime we get the possible chance to come and see her we're caught up with other matters that we have to attend. I'll have to make some extra time for just me and him. We don't want our '*sacred bond*' being less sacred.

"Hey Razz. You haven't happened to see Catra around have you."

"Catra? Oh Catra. Yes yes I remember her. She's off learning how to bake pie with Luna."

Confused I look to Swift Wind for answers. His expression reflects my own and he shrugs his wings in answer.

"Razz, Catra and I don't know anyone called…"

BONK

Razz's broom hits the top of my head. Thanks stars the hair poof lessens the impact, but it still hurts a bit. I really need to learn to dodge her broom bonks. Swift Wind tries his best not to laugh as I rub the area of my head that's starting to throb.

Razz pays no attention to this and continues to speak...

"Don't be silly Adora. Luna and you are good friends. She speaks highly of you for taking such good care of Catra. Besides, I know how eager she is too meet you. In fact, I think Melog is on their way to get you. Now if you excuse me Madam Razz has to go and find some sugar for the pie."

Before I can even question Razz she disappears into the Whispering Woods. I would have followed her but she went so quickly. Even Swift Wind didn't see what direction she went.

"What was that all about?" Swift Wind asks. They're as confused as I am.

"I'm not sure. Maybe we should just head home. It's almost midday and…"

Rustle

A faint sound comes from the bushes behind us. Swift Wind and I turn prepared to attack. I summon She-Ra's sword but not the warrior within. This might be Razz for all we know but it doesn't hurt to be prepared in case it isn't. There's been many new, mysterious but sometimes dangerous creatures lurking in these parts.

Suddenly a creature jumps out from the bushes. I instantly recognize who they are…

"MELOG!"

I call as I run over to them, giving them a tight squeeze. I look back over to the bushes and become increasingly worried when I realise that they are alone. They look distressed. Their mane is a shade of orange and red. Their eyes show great concern and worry.

"Melog what's wrong? Where's Catra?"

They try their best to communicate with me but they're talking extremely fast. It doesn't help that I can't understand them properly either. What I do pick up on though their form of communicating are three words…

"Catra… tro uble… ruins."

Catra's in trouble at the ruins of Halfmoon. I knew something was wrong. I should have trusted my gut instinct.

My worries temporarily stun when my mind takes me back to my cadet survival training…

"Swift Wind fly back to Brightmoon and alter Glimmer and Bow that Catra needs our help. Get them to meet Melog and I at

Halfmoon’s ruins. Ask them to bring Scorpia and Entrapta with them. I need you to stay back at Brightmoon with Micah in case Catra somehow makes it back there before me. If you happen to find her before then tell me throughout scared bond.”

“Roger that Adora. You can count on me.”

Swift Wind salutes with his right wing as he takes off into the sky at full speed.

Then and only then do I turn back to Melog. They can sense my worry and I can tell they’re upset feeling that they have let me down. I do my best to reassure them…

“Don’t worry Melog. We’ll find Catra. Can you take me to her?”

Melog does their best to smile. They turn to face the direction they came from and encourage me to climb onto their back so they can take me to her. I recon they ran a long way as usually I would run alongside them. The Whispering Woods must have been shifting when they were trying to find me, almost as if something was fighting against them. I'm not sure why I feel that way but I can sense it.

Once ready Melog starts to charge into the Whispering Woods, taking me back to where this nightmare began.

“Hang in there Catra. I’m on my way.”

--

“She’s not here? I don’t understand. What could have happened to her?”

Melog and I met the others at the ruins of Halfmoon, where they then led us to where a rock slide had trapped Catra in one of the

caves tunnels. I called to her but there was no answer on the other side. I wanted to turn into She-Ra to clear the wreckage but Bow warned me that that wasn't the best idea. If we moved one rock incorrectly it could trigger another land slide. We worked quickly and effectively to make a safe, clear passage but Catra's not here.

Panic has started to set in an I'm not sure what to do or where she might have gone.

"Maybe her survival instincts from the Horde kicked in and she tried to find her own way out. I know that's what I'd do if I was in her situation." Scorpia suggests.

I didn't think of that. Catra might have found her own way out. She might still be okay and all we have to do is find out which way she went.

"Look. Down there!" Glimmer says pointing towards a series of lights.

We follow the illuminating glow, which we soon discover to flammable touches that guide us down a long tunnel. Hope starts to build deep inside when I sense that we are getting close to something. I can feel it.

Melog also states that they have picked up on a trail. It's faint but they can still detect Catra. We start to pick up the pace, Melog and I leading the way. Sadly for us when the touches run out we hit a dead end.

"No… No, no, no it can be a dead end! There's got to be something more here. She has to be here."

Fear and anger sets in as my worst fears start to surface.

This is not how our story is supposed to go. She has to be okay. She has to have made it out of here alive. I can't lose her again… I can't fail her again.

Bow comes to my side as tears threaten to fall from my eyes. He tries is best to comfort me…

"It's okay Adora. Maybe it's just a dead end. I imagine Catra found another way out."

"It's not that simple Bow! Why would there be touches leading us this way for this to be the end. Even Melog said they picked up her scent heading down here."

Now Glimmer tries to comfort me but I can feel my frustration quickly building…

"We'll find her Adora. Maybe Melog picked up on her scent because just like us she came this way first. I'm sure she made it out. I'm sure she's okay."

"We don't know that Glimmer. We don't know that. I know Catra, she's good at hiding things, even when things aren't okay. She was like that back on Darla after I got her back from… *from him*. I can't lose her again! I lost her once before and now I don't even know where she is. I don't know if she's okay or if she's safe and IT'S ALL MY FAULT!"

Blinded by fear of losing the woman I love and anger that I have let it happen, She-Ra appears out of nowhere. She takes control of my body and the sword clangs aggressively against the wall in frustration. The force alone should have caused another rock slide but no, the once dead end fall away, *glitching as Entrapta would say*, revealing a hidden passage.

Just as quick as the opening appeared She-Ra fades. My connection somehow lost to her.

"Fascinating." Entrapta says as she takes documented pictures of what we are witnessing.

"What is this place?" Glimmer asks, memorised by the sight.

“I don’t know but we’re going to find out. Melog can you cloak us?”

Mreow - Melog looks sad after they fail to turn us invisible.

Something’s wrong.

“Adora… I can’t feel any magical connection down here. I can’t even teleport.”

Glimmer’s voice sounds overcome with worry. I look to Scorpia who silently confirms that she feels the same way. If they have lost their connection to their magical abilities then maybe this has some form of connection as to why She-Ra also abruptly disappeared.

Something is definitely very wrong. Guess we'll have to make this quick.

“Alright everyone. Melog, Glimmer, Scorpia, keep trying to use your powers. Until we know what this place is and why we can’t use our powers we’ll need to keep a low profile. Our mission is to find Catra, make sure she is safe and get out of here as quick as possible. I suggest we start searching in there. Everyone clear of the plan?”

The area I’m on about searching first looks to be a giant castle carved into the mountain walls. If Catra is here and is for some reason being held prisoner she might be being held in a cell of some from. Maybe even a room like when Brightmoon captured Shadow Weaver and Double trouble. Thankfully for us Entrapta’s tech-pad still seems to be working for now so we can keep an eye on where everyone is.

The team nod in agreement, confirming that they understand the plan…

“Good. Let’s go.”

--

"FOR FUCK SAKE! Why does this always happen to us? Can't we just have one mission go smoothly… ONE MISSION, that's all I ask."

Glimmer throws her fists up in frustration as we run through the castle grounds. I'm placing bets that she is the one who swears the most out of all of us the most.

Somehow we have been detected. We've been extra cautious to keep a low, hidden profile but our effort have proved useless. We are being chase by some Etherians, Etherians who I think are a new presence but I don't have time to stop and work out what species they are.

"I say we split up. If we split up they'll have to do the same. We have a better chance of finding Catra that way."

Bow makes his suggestion clear as he topples over a series of tables and plants that line the corridor. We're avoiding using arrows at the moment in case they're needed for a more serious attack. The blocked path cause some of the chasers to stop in their tracks but others jump over them and climb across the wall expertly, before landing on all fours.

I've seen those skills before. Catra sometimes did that in our cadet training simulations… could it be? Are they…

BOOM-*HISS*

A smoke bomb explodes to the side of us, making us take an immediate turn. It also makes me come back to my senses and out of daydream land. Bow's suggestion sounds like the most reasonable one. If we split up in pairs we can find Catra more quickly and have someone to watch each other's back.

“Bow and Glimmer search the outer castle grounds. Scorpia and Entrapta you take the lower levels. Melog and I will head to the top and see if we can find anything. If you have to attack, use defensive techniques only.”

All of them nod in agreement and provide Melog and I with cover so we can get ahead undetected. The guards seem to follow the others, giving Melog and I some quite time to search the upper levels of the castle.

It’s surprisingly quite up here, especially with everything going on. You’d expect the whole castle to be guarded but I guess not. Strange when you think of it.

Melog starts to follow a certain trail but stops and growls slightly. Their mane becomes a deep shade of red and I try to summon She-Ra but with no luck… *guess you’re fight your way out of this the old way Adora.*

Melog and I prepare to attack when a small creature lands on the floor in front of us…

SCREECH

A small Etherian Moon Owl lands at our feet and looks up at us. However, this is no ordinary Etherian Moon Owl. This is the exact same one that's been following Catra and I around for weeks.

“How on Etheria did you get in here? It’s not safe. You have to go.”

The owl looks up at me, clearly ignoring my words. They screech again and starts to fly in circles around Melog and I. They keeps looking down the corridor as if trying to get me to follow them. After a moment or two, the owl decides to fly behind me and gives me a gentle push on my back… *okay, they definitely wants me to follow them.*

Wasting no more time, Melog and I follow the owl further down the corridor. As we go, Melog and I give the owl a questioning

look. It's not everyday you find yourself following an owl but today is clearly one of those days. The owl screeches once more before stopping in front of two large doors. They turn to us, fluffs up and then flies out of the window behind us, leaving us all alone once more.

Melog gives the doors sniff before making low mumbling noise. They look up at me encouragingly, as if saying to try opening it. I give it a few experimental pulls and pushes but they appear to be sealed tight. Melog starts scratching at the doors. They can sense someone is on the other side, probably someone who needs our help.

What if it's Catra?

Fueled with hope and worry, I desperately start to make stronger advancements against the doors. One last big push on the count of three should do it…

One… two… three…

BANG

The once stiff doors swing open. As a result Melog and I almost end up tripping over one other. I'm so glad we didn't as that would have been embarrassing. Whilst I'm regaining my footing I hear Melog perk up besides me, making their usually happy trill. Following their line of sight, I realise who we have found. My heart skips a beat when the love of my life smiles back at me...

"Hey Adora."

End Notes

Hope you enjoyed reading this extra chapter for Finding Halfmoon. We're officially halfway through the main story and still have two extra content chapters to come. Thank you all for your support. It means the world to me.

I hoped you like the little part about Angella's memorial. It was something I knew I wanted to add to this fic when it was in the planning stages. I glad I was able to bring this part to life and I hope I did it justice.

Please let me know what you thought in the comments. I love hearing your thoughts. I hope to see you at the next Finding Halfmoon chapter release. 😊

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!